Vijayaraghavachari's age and experience should have been so flustered shows how SSNCo had exhausted every one of its well-wishers.

In August 1910, the police reported once again that the company was 'practically on its last legs and will be wound up shortly', although they confessed that it was becoming difficult to gather reliable information.[39]

Meanwhile, in September, SSNCo moved its office from Beach Road to a building in Melur, away from the main business district.[40] This was probably indicative of its final collapse.

At the same time S. Parthasarathy met S.D. Krishna Aiyangar in Madurai and accompanied him to Tuticorin. There was now no ambiguity about the purpose of the visit: all that was left to be done was to wind up the company as it had 'suffered heavy losses and has practically no financial resources'.[41]

A month or so later, at the beginning of November, Thirumalai Aiyangar, manager of Pandithurai Thevar, broke journey at Tuticorin on his return from Colombo, to claim Rs 800 due to his principal.[42] It was the height of irony that a philanthropist, perhaps even an angel investor—if it may not be anachronistic to use the word—who had invested tens of thousands of rupees in a sinking company should be despatching his manager to make a paltry collection.

By then all resources had been exhausted. The public were experiencing fatigue while everyone connected with the company had strained their last financial nerve. All news of the *Lawoe* ceases by this time. According to *Shipping & Mercantile Gazette* and *Lloyd's List*, the *Lawoe* and the *Gallia* made no voyages during the year, except one. There is one entry for the *Lawoe* leaving Tuticorin on 18 May 1910 and arriving more than a month later at Calcutta on 26 June.[43] Perhaps this was on the demand of prospective buyers?

By June 1910 or thereabouts, the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company had ceased operations. The last that we hear of the company is from a most unlikely source. In early 1911, W.M. Coates published *The Old 'Country Trade' of the East Indies*, a short, factual history of coastal trade in India.[44]